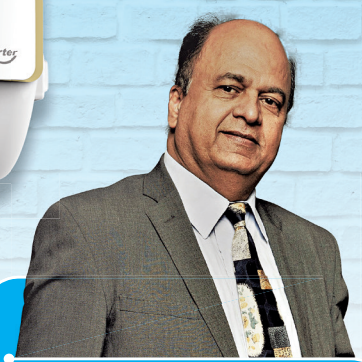


Voltas launches India's first AC with HEPA Filter



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Mr. Pradeep Bakshi
Managing Director & CEO
Voltas Ltd

TECH INNOVATION DRIVE ON

With government pressure on to focus on developing more energy-efficient, eco-friendly air conditioners, manufacturers are turning to innovative technological solutions in the race to replace key refrigerants such as CFCs that are now being phased out.

Air conditioners today have been transformed by leaps and bounds from the days when it was all about just keeping your rooms cool. Driven by the need for more pertinent cooling solutions, the industry has turned its lens on more energy- efficient models through advanced technologies to harness emissions of greenhouse gases in the new models they are putting out there in the market. Energy efficient, energy saving, environment friendly–'green technology' is the buzzword that has put the industry in the spin, with government also clamping down on ozone-invasive products.

Transforming the functioning of air conditioners today are sensors with smart cooling solutions using revolutionary technologies such as iSee technology. An important feature of iSee is minimizing the wastage of cooling. A unique aspect of the technology is that it can detect how many people are there in the room, their location, their activity etc and adjusts its cooling for maximum comfort. It can also sense if there is no one in the room and switches the AC off automatically to avoid cooling wastage. The new models of both Hitachi and Daikin are equipped with smart human presence detector sensors. Another feature is Follow Me, which involves a sensor placed inside the remote, the information from which then helps the AC to adjust the ambient temperature. Blue Star ACs have 5 different sensors to deliver Precise Cooling Technology (PCT), which tasks them to adjust the temperature with the precision level of 0.1oC.

A smart phone tech app to control ACs has been developed by the likes of Hitachi with its Wi-Fi connect technology linked with a router. Even if the router or Wi-FI link is absent, one can still connect the smartphone with the AC using the WiFi Direct feature.

Companies like LG, Hitachi and BlueStar, have come up with new AC models equipped with the 4D swing function (up-down + right-left) which blows the cool air in multiple directions to ensure uniform cooling inside the room.

Aircon honcho, Voltas from the Tata group, envisages the residential AC segment to grow in terms of both volume and value this summer. "Voltas as a market leader has always stayed at the helm of innovation and broken the clutter with its differentiated propositions. In the past few years, we have seen an increased demand for products that come with health features and advanced technology. This was re-emphasized in the latest survey by Voltas where 77% of Indians said they wanted to upgrade their ACs with UVC technology that will quickly clean indoor air by killing pollutants, germs and pathogens, "shares Pradeep Bakshi, Managing Director & CEO, Voltas Ltd



Being a consumer centric-brand, the company he says, has considered the needs of its consumers and launched India's first AC with HEPA Filter technology that purifies indoor air. The product, he elaborates, comes with an AQI indicator and a PM 1.0 sensor, along with 6 different tonnage modes; to serve the customised needs of customers.

This year, the company has shifted its focus towards resurgence and re-alignment, given the changing consumer demands. "At Voltas, we have prioritised - agility, consumer centricity, and the next level of digitization. We also want to offer a hassle free buying experience to our customers across tiers and demographics. We have expanded our customer touchpoints to 24,000 outlets; including 190+ exclusive stores centres for in-person engagement. We are aware that some consumers are keen on online purchases and our new Voltas web lounge (www.voltaslounge.com) is catering to those who want to buy from the comfort of their homes," says Pradeep Bakshi, Managing Director & CEO, Voltas Ltd